THE MONUMENTS MUST GO: Reflecting on Opportunities for Campus Conversations

《纪念碑必须拆除：关于校园对话机会的反思》

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Note: The following letter appeared in Slate on August 16, 2017. We reprint this letter here with permission.

注：以下信件于 2017 年 8 月 16 日刊登于《Slate》。经许可，我们在此重印这封信。

Dear Richmond Mayor Levar Stoney and members of the Monument Avenue Commission,

致里士满市长 Levar Stoney 及纪念碑大道委员会各位委员：

We are native Richmonders and also the great-great-grandsons of Stonewall Jackson. As two of the closest living relatives to Stonewall, we are writing today to ask for the removal of his statue, as well as the removal of all Confederate statues from Monument Avenue. They are overt symbols of racism and white supremacy, and the time is long overdue for them to depart from public display. Overnight, Baltimore has seen fit to take this action. Richmond should, too.

我们出生并成长于里士满，也是“石墙”杰克逊的玄孙。作为杰克逊目前仍在世、血缘关系最近的亲属之一，我们今天写信，是希望他的雕像被移除，也希望纪念碑大道上的所有南方邦联雕像都被移除。它们是赤裸的种族主义与白人至上主义象征，早就应该退出公共展示。巴尔的摩在一夜之间已经采取了这样的行动，里士满也应该如此。

In making this request, we wish to express our respect and admiration for Mayor Stoney’s leadership while also strongly disagreeing with his claim that “removal of symbols does [nothing] for telling the actual truth [nor] changes the state and culture of racism in this country today.” In our view, the removal of the Jackson statue and others will necessarily further difficult conversations about racial justice. It will begin to tell the truth of us all coming to our senses.

提出这一请求时，我们希望表达对 Stoney 市长领导工作的尊重与赞赏，但我们也强烈不同意他的说法，即“移除这些象征对于讲述真正的事实[没有任何作用]，[也不会]改变这个国家今天种族主义的状况与文化”。在我们看来，移除杰克逊雕像以及其他雕像，必然会进一步推动关于种族正义的艰难对话。这将开始讲述一个事实：我们所有人正在逐渐清醒过来。

Last weekend, Charlottesville showed us unequivocally that Confederate statues offer pre-existing iconography for racists. The people who descended on Charlottesville last weekend were there to make a naked show of force for white supremacy. To them, the Robert E. Lee statue is a clear symbol of their hateful ideology. The Confederate statues on Monument Avenue are, too—especially Jackson, who faces north, supposedly as if to continue the fight.

上周末，夏洛茨维尔发生的事情明确告诉我们，南方邦联雕像为种族主义者提供了一套现成的图像符号。上周末聚集到夏洛茨维尔的人，就是为了赤裸裸地展示白人至上主义的力量。对他们而言，罗伯特·E·李的雕像清楚地象征着他们充满仇恨的意识形态；纪念碑大道上的南方邦联雕像也是如此，尤其是面朝北方的杰克逊雕像，仿佛仍要继续战斗。

We are writing to say that we understand justice very differently from our grandfather’s grandfather, and we wish to make it clear his statue does not represent us.

我们写这封信，是想说明，我们对于“正义”的理解与我们祖父的祖父截然不同，也希望明确表示：他的雕像并不代表我们。

Through our upbringing and education, we have learned much about Stonewall Jackson. We have learned about his reluctance to fight and his teaching of Sunday School to enslaved peoples in Lexington, Virginia, a potentially criminal activity at the time. We have learned how thoughtful and loving he was toward his family. But we cannot ignore his decision to own slaves, his decision to go to war for the Confederacy, and, ultimately, the fact that he was a white man fighting on the side of white supremacy.

在成长和受教育的过程中，我们了解了许多关于“石墙”杰克逊的事情。我们知道他曾不愿参战，也知道他曾在弗吉尼亚州列克星敦为被奴役者教授主日学——这在当时可能构成违法行为。我们也知道他对家人十分体贴、充满爱意。但我们无法忽视他选择拥有奴隶、选择为南方邦联参战，以及归根结底，他作为一名白人站在白人至上主义一方作战这一事实。

While we are not ashamed of our great-great-grandfather, we are ashamed to benefit from white supremacy while our black family and friends suffer. We are ashamed of the monument.

我们并不为自己的高祖父感到羞耻，但当我们的黑人家人和朋友承受痛苦时，我们却从白人至上主义中获益，这使我们感到羞耻。我们为这座纪念碑感到羞耻。

In fact, instead of lauding Jackson's violence, we choose to celebrate Stonewall's sister—our great-great-grandaunt—Laura Jackson Arnold. As an adult Laura became a staunch Unionist and abolitionist. Though she and Stonewall were incredibly close through childhood, she never spoke to Stonewall after his decision to support the Confederacy. We choose to stand on the right side of history with Laura Jackson Arnold.

事实上，与其赞颂杰克逊的暴力，我们更愿意纪念“石墙”杰克逊的妹妹——我们的高姑祖母 Laura Jackson Arnold。成年后，Laura 成为坚定的联邦支持者和废奴主义者。尽管她与“石墙”杰克逊在童年时期关系极为亲密，但在杰克逊决定支持南方邦联之后，她再也没有与他说过话。我们选择与 Laura Jackson Arnold 一同站在历史正确的一边。

Confederate monuments like the Jackson statue were never intended as benign symbols. Rather, they were the clearly articulated artwork of white supremacy. Among many examples, we can see this plainly if we look at the dedication of a Confederate statue at the University of North Carolina, in which a speaker proclaimed that the Confederate soldier "saved the very life of the Anglo-Saxon race in the South." Disturbingly, he went on to recount a tale of performing the "pleasing duty" of "horse whipping" a black woman in front of federal soldiers. All over the South, this grotesque message is conveyed by similar monuments. As importantly, this message is clear to today's avowed white supremacists.

像杰克逊雕像这样的南方邦联纪念碑，从来就不是作为无害的象征而建造的。相反，它们是对白人至上主义明确而直接的艺术表达。在许多例子中，北卡罗来纳大学一座南方邦联雕像的揭幕仪式尤其能说明这一点：当时一名演讲者宣称，南方邦联士兵“拯救了南方盎格鲁-撒克逊种族的生命本身”。更令人不安的是，他随后还讲述了自己曾在联邦士兵面前“令人愉快地履行职责”，用马鞭抽打一名黑人女性的故事。类似纪念碑遍布美国南方，传递着同样令人厌恶的信息。同样重要的是，对于今天公开宣称自己是白人至上主义者的人来说，这一信息依然十分清楚。

There is also historical evidence that the statues on Monument Avenue were rejected by black Richmonders at the time of their construction. In the 1870s, John Mitchell, a black city councilman, called the monuments a tribute to "blood and treason" and voiced strong opposition to the use of public funds for building them. Speaking about the Lee Memorial, he vowed that there would come a time when African Americans would "be there to take it down."

历史证据也表明，纪念碑大道上的这些雕像在建造之时就遭到里士满黑人居民的反对。19 世纪 70 年代，黑人市议员 John Mitchell 称这些纪念碑是在向“鲜血与叛国”致敬，并强烈反对使用公共资金修建它们。谈到李将军纪念碑时，他预言终有一天，非裔美国人会“在那里把它拆下来”。

Ongoing racial disparities in incarceration, educational attainment, police brutality, hiring practices, access to health care, and, perhaps most starkly, wealth, make it clear that these monuments do not stand somehow outside of history. Racism and white supremacy, which undoubtedly continue today, are neither natural nor inevitable. Rather, they were created in order to justify the unjustifiable, in particular slavery.

在监禁率、教育成就、警察暴力、招聘实践、医疗服务获取，以及或许最明显的财富方面，持续存在的种族差距清楚表明，这些纪念碑并不是某种置身历史之外的存在。种族主义和白人至上主义无疑延续至今，但它们既非自然形成，也非不可避免。相反，它们被创造出来，是为了给本来无法辩护的事物提供正当性，尤其是奴隶制。

One thing that bonds our extended family, besides our common ancestor, is that many have worked, often as clergy and as educators, for justice in their communities. While we do not purport to speak for all of Stonewall's kin, our sense of justice leads us to believe that removing the Stonewall statue and other monuments should be part of a larger project of actively mending the racial disparities that hundreds of years of white supremacy have wrought. We hope other descendants of Confederate generals will stand with us.

除了共同的祖先之外，我们这个大家族还有一点将彼此联系在一起：许多家族成员都曾为所在社区的正义事业工作，常常以牧师或教育者的身份参与其中。我们并不声称能够代表“石墙”杰克逊的所有亲属发言，但我们对正义的理解使我们相信，移除杰克逊雕像和其他纪念碑，应当成为一个更大工程的一部分，

即主动修补数百年白人至上主义所造成的种族差距。我们希望其他南方邦联将领的后代也能与我们站在一起。

As cities all over the South are realizing now, we are not in need of added context. We are in need of a new context—one in which the statues have been taken down.

正如美国南方各地的城市如今逐渐意识到的那样，我们需要的不是为这些雕像增加更多“背景说明”，而是一个新的背景——一个这些雕像已经被移除的背景。

Respectfully,
William Jackson Christian
Warren Edmund Christian
Great-great-grandsons of Thomas Jonathan “Stonewall” Jackson

谨致敬意,
William Jackson Christian
Warren Edmund Christian
Thomas Jonathan “Stonewall” Jackson 的玄孙

WARREN: Since Jack and I released our open letter asking for the monument of our great-great-grandfather Confederate General Thomas “Stonewall” Jackson to be removed, many people have expressed concern over the feedback we must be receiving. While I have received lots of feedback, the overwhelming majority has been positive. The few negative emails I have received have been mostly cordial, and none has come close to bordering on threats. This is a far cry from what Takiyah Thompson, who scaled a Confederate statue in Durham, North Carolina, looped a rope around its neck, and let the crowd “decide if they wanted to pull it down or not” has faced (Democracy Now). While the white privilege Jack and I enjoy has allowed our dissent to be tolerated even by people who disagree with us, Thompson has been subjected to racist white rage—both from individuals and from the state. She was denied service at a Durham bar, received death threats from white nationalists, and faced felony charges. Many well-wishers have praised our courage in speaking out; however, this pales in comparison to Thompson’s bravery. Her act was also much more effective. The monument in Durham is down while the Stonewall statue in Richmond does not appear to be going anywhere anytime soon.

WARREN：自从 Jack 和我发表公开信，要求移除我们高祖父——南方邦联将领 Thomas “Stonewall” Jackson——的纪念碑之后，很多人都向我们表达担忧，觉得我们一定收到了大量负面反馈。我的确收到过很多反馈，但绝大多数都是积极的。少数负面邮件也大多态度克制，没有任何一封接近威胁。相比之下，这与 Takiyah Thompson 所面对的情况相去甚远。她曾爬上一座位于北卡罗来纳州达勒姆的南方邦联雕像，把绳子套在雕像脖子上，然后让人群“决定他们是否想把它拉倒”（Democracy Now）。Jack 和我享有的白人特权，使得即便不同意我们的人也能容忍我们的异议；而 Thompson 却遭受了带有种族主义色彩的白人愤怒——既来自个人，也来自国家机器。她在达勒姆的一家酒吧被拒绝服务，收到白人民族主义者的死亡威胁，还面临重罪指控。许多支持者称赞我们公开发声的勇气，但与 Thompson 的勇敢相比，这根本不值一提。她的行动也有效得多：达勒姆的纪念碑已经倒下，而里士满的“石墙”杰克逊雕像似乎短期内仍不会被移走。

I owe Takiyah Thompson and the other courageous Durham activists a debt of gratitude because it was their act of revolutionary democracy that sparked our letter. I attended the rally at the Durham courthouse that preceded the toppling of the Confederate monument. My partner and I listened to a few speeches, and then we got hungry and bored, so we went to eat. The fairly small, peaceful protest we witnessed is totally at odds with the felony charges of inciting a riot that Thompson and others faced. It was by no means a riot. While we were eating near the courthouse, my partner saw on social media that the statue had just been toppled. We gathered a few friends and raced to the scene. We spent a moment celebrating and paying our disrespect to the crumpled symbol of white supremacy that had stood guard in front of the courthouse making it clear exactly who could and could not expect to receive justice inside. Standing in front of the now grounded hollow statue, I have never felt so proud to be a resident of Durham. On the way home, I excitedly called Jack, who also called Durham home for a time, to spread the good news. In our elation, Jack and I decided it was finally time to take a public stand against Confederate monuments.

我非常感激 Takiyah Thompson 和达勒姆其他勇敢的行动者，因为正是他们这种革命性的民主行动促成了我们的公开信。我参加了达勒姆法院前的一场集会，那场集会发生在南方邦联纪念碑被推倒之前。我和伴侣

听了几场演讲，后来觉得又饿又无聊，就去吃东西了。我们看到的是一场规模不大、相当和平的抗议，这与 Thompson 等人后来面对的“煽动骚乱”重罪指控完全不相符。那绝不是一场骚乱。我们在法院附近吃饭时，我的伴侣从社交媒体上看到，雕像刚刚被推倒。我们叫上几个朋友，立刻赶到现场。我们在那里庆祝了一会儿，也对那座倒在地上的白人至上主义象征表达了我们的不敬。过去，这座空心雕像一直守在法院前，明确告诉人们，究竟谁能够、谁又不能期待从里面获得正义。站在已经倒地的雕像前，我从未如此为自己是达勒姆居民而感到自豪。回家的路上，我兴奋地给 Jack 打电话——他也曾有一段时间把达勒姆当作自己的家——告诉他这个好消息。在兴奋之中，我们一致认为，终于到了公开反对南方邦联纪念碑的时候。

It was not long after I had started my graduate student career at the University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill that I learned of the context surrounding the erection of the Confederate statue Silent Sam that is mentioned in our letter. Since learning of Julian Carr’s hate-filled and explicitly white supremacist dedication, I have been offended by the statue’s presence on campus. I’d thought of writing a letter regarding Silent Sam for years, but I was wary of presuming that anyone gave a damn what an ancestor of a Confederate general thought about a monument and relying on the very privilege afforded by the white supremacy we seek to disrupt. Thompson’s and others’ direct action suggested to my brother and me that the time was ripe for removing these symbols of white supremacy. Jack and I hoped that, at the very least, advocates for monument removal would be able to use our letter in service of rebutting the common argument about heritage enlisted as support for the monuments.

我在北卡罗来纳大学教堂山分校开始研究生学习后不久，就了解到了我们公开信中提到的南方邦联雕像“Silent Sam”（沉默的山姆）竖立时的历史背景。得知 Julian Carr 在揭幕仪式上发表过充满仇恨、明确宣扬白人至上主义的演说之后，这座雕像继续存在于校园中一直令我感到不适。多年来，我都想过要写一封关于 Silent Sam 的信，但我担心这样做会预设别人很在乎一个南方邦联将领的后代如何看待一座纪念碑，同时又依赖于我们正试图打破的白人至上主义赋予我的特权。Thompson 等人的直接行动让我的弟弟和我意识到，移除这些白人至上主义象征的时机已经成熟。Jack 和我至少希望，那些主张移除纪念碑的人能够利用我们的信，回应一种常见论点，即把“传统遗产”当作支持这些纪念碑继续存在的理由。

Jack and I each crafted a separate letter that Monday—the same night that Thompson provided others the opportunity to pull down the statue in Durham. After an intensive process of combining our letters, editing, receiving input from our gracious partners, and rewriting, we settled on our final version Wednesday evening. A few hours later, it appeared on slate.com. On Thursday morning, Jack and I were guests on Democracy Now!

那个星期一，也就是 Thompson 让其他人有机会推倒达勒姆雕像的同一天晚上，Jack 和我分别起草了一封信。经过一番密集的合并、编辑、听取我们伴侣的意见以及反复改写之后，我们在星期三晚上确定了最终版本。几个小时后，这封信发表在 slate.com 上。星期四早晨，Jack 和我作为嘉宾参加了 Democracy Now! 节目。

Since then, an unexpected response was how our letter has been taken up by university campuses as part of a larger conversation regarding Confederate monuments as well as monuments in general. In particular, Jack and I heard from other teachers—many people we knew and many who have reached out to us since August—who let us know they planned to use the letter in their classes. That our letter would be presented as a teaching tool was a welcome surprise. Since Jack and I are both educators and both engaged with teaching writing, we wanted to take a moment to offer our reflections on how our letter relates to the teaching contexts we inhabit. Jack will have more opportunity to work with the letter directly in his teaching; his experience informs the next section.

此后，一个出乎我们意料的反应是，这封信被许多大学校园纳入了关于南方邦联纪念碑乃至纪念碑问题本身的更大讨论。尤其是，Jack 和我收到了其他教师的消息——其中有不少是我们认识的人，也有很多人是在八月之后主动联系我们——他们告诉我们，打算在课堂上使用这封信。我们的信竟会被作为教学材料，这是一种令人欣喜的意外。Jack 和我都是教育工作者，也都从事写作教学，因此我们想花一点时间反思，这封信与我们所处的教学环境之间有什么关系。Jack 在自己的教学中会有更多机会直接使用这封信，下一部分便以他的经验为基础。

JACK: When Warren and I appeared on Democracy Now! in mid-August to discuss our letter, the host Amy Goodman, noting that we are both educators employed by universities, asked us what we would tell our students about our decision to write. The question came to me first and I said, “I don’t know but I’m glad to have until September 6th to think about it” before Warren then gave a more thoughtful answer.

JACK：八月中旬，Warren 和我登上 Democracy Now! 讨论我们的公开信时，主持人 Amy Goodman 注意到我们两人都受雇于大学、都是教育工作者，于是问我们：对于决定写这封信这件事，我们会对自己的学生说些什么。问题先问到我，我回答：“我不知道，不过我很庆幸自己可以一直想到 9 月 6 日。”随后 Warren 给出了一个更有思考的回答。

Two months later, the fall semester was in full swing. I was teaching four sections of first-year writing in my sixth year as a full-time temporary instructor, and I still didn’t know quite how our letter should be best presented in my own—or others’—writing classes.

两个月后，秋季学期已经全面开始。那是我作为全职临时讲师的第六年，我同时教授四个一年级写作班，但我依然不知道，究竟应该怎样在我自己的——或者别人的——写作课上最好地呈现我们的这封信。

This is not to say my students were not very much on my mind in the days just after the white nationalist riots in Charlottesville that killed Heather Heyer. When I first saw pictures of young white nationalist demonstrators holding tiki torches, it was not hard to imagine my own students, who are overwhelmingly white, as being part of the crowd. So many of the protesters looked, dressed, and walked like some of my students. They had similar posture and similar haircuts. To me, this connection was visceral, and whether it was fair or not, it was a connection I could not help but make.

这并不是说，在夏洛茨维尔那场导致 Heather Heyer 死亡的白人民族主义者骚乱之后的几天里，我没有一直想到自己的学生。当我第一次看到那些年轻的白人民族主义示威者举着 tiki 火把的照片时，我并不难想象自己的学生——他们绝大多数是白人——也可能身处那群人之中。许多抗议者的长相、穿着和走路方式都像我的一些学生，他们有相似的姿态和相似的发型。对我来说，这种联系是非常直接、甚至带有身体感的；无论这种联想是否公平，我都无法阻止自己这样想。

This connection was then re-enforced when I read about Peter Cvjetanovic, whose image—in full-throated yell on the University of Virginia campus—was plastered immediately over the internet and television. After being identified in the photo, Cvjetanovic, a twenty-year-old University of Nevada student, made equivocating statements that being “pro-white” did not make him “anti-anybody else” (KTVN-TV). He tried also to claim that he had not known quite what he had gotten himself into. I’m not saying I buy Cvjetanovic’s statements—particularly his claim that he just wanted to “see Richard Spencer,” as if the spectacle could be absolved of politics—but what is interesting to me is that his statements and his apparent naiveté sounded in tone and content like the kind of excuses I sometimes hear from my own students. In turn, this makes me think more deeply about the ways in which teachers can and should intervene when students espouse racist ideology.

后来，当我读到 Peter Cvjetanovic 的报道时，这种联系又被进一步强化。他在弗吉尼亚大学校园上张口高喊的照片迅速传遍互联网和电视。照片中的人被辨认出来后，这名 20 岁的内华达大学学生含糊其辞地表示，自己“支持白人（pro-white）”并不意味着“反对其他任何人”（KTVN-TV）。他还试图声称，自己当时并不完全清楚究竟卷入了什么。我并不是说我相信 Cvjetanovic 的说法——尤其是他说自己只是想“去看看 Richard Spencer”，仿佛只要把这件事看作一场奇观，就可以剥离其中的政治性——但让我感兴趣的是，他的说法以及那种显得天真的态度，无论语气还是内容，都很像我有时从自己学生那里听到的借口。这也促使我更深入地思考：当学生表达种族主义意识形态时，教师能够、又应该以何种方式介入。

Asking this question has prompted me to remember that my first introduction to Breitbart, InfoWars, and other websites identifying themselves as “The Alt-Right” came from one of my students. In the spring of 2015, a student in my one of my first-year writing classes—I’ll call him Toby—wrote a blatantly racist and woefully inadequate research essay that basically argued that most claims of police brutality were hoaxes. When I confronted him about this, I started by addressing his sources and the fact that they did not meet the criteria of being reputable news sites, a consideration that we had discussed in class. We looked together at reporting from the New York Times and elsewhere about the mission of sites like Breitbart, and I was able to ask him if these beliefs were his. He replied that they were not, but they did reflect the beliefs of his family members. About his family, he said, “They aren’t really college people.” In the end, I did not

push back much on what appeared to be his own racism, but I did require him to rewrite his research essay with reputable sources.

这个问题让我想起，我最早接触 Breitbart、InfoWars 以及其他自称属于“另类右翼（Alt-Right）”的网站，其实就是通过一名学生。2015 年春季，我一个一年级写作班里的学生——这里称他为 Toby——写了一篇公然带有种族主义色彩、而且研究质量极差的论文，核心观点基本是：大多数有关警察暴力的指控都是骗局。我与他谈这件事时，首先从资料来源入手，指出他使用的网站不符合“可靠新闻网站”的标准，而这一标准我们此前已经在课堂上讨论过。我们一起查看了《纽约时报》等媒体对于 Breitbart 这类网站宗旨的报道，我也借此问他，这些观点是否就是他本人的观点。他回答说不是，但这些确实反映了他家人的看法。谈到自己的家人时，他说：“他们并不是真正上过大学的那种人。”最后，对于看起来属于他本人的种族主义，我并没有进行太多正面反驳，但我要求他使用可靠资料重新写这篇研究论文。

And he did. In the end, it was still a marginal essay at best. His grade changed from an F to a C. I felt my intervention with him had been somewhat positive but also incomplete. We had a thirty-minute conversation, and then an even briefer one when I handed his paper back and complimented him for the effort he had put into his rewrite, which was both substantial and deserving of a higher grade. But what had he learned? He had maybe learned how to be a better researcher and that Breitbart and other similar sites would not fly as a secondary source in an academic class. If anything, he probably learned better to conceal his racist beliefs in future academic endeavors. I lamented that I had no real recourse to follow up with him, nowhere specific to send him except onward to sophomore year. This assignment and our discussion had taken place at the end of the semester. He had arrived poorly prepared for the work of our class, and he was leaving it only slightly better prepared to succeed in future writing situations. He was one of 75 students I had that semester. I had a good number of other students actively seeking me out for extra help, whereas with Toby it was clear that I would have to initiate all one-on-one discussions. On top of that, I was also in the process of attempting to get rehired—a process that consumed my time and attention—and incentivized me not to push too hard with students whom I needed to evaluate me positively, much less draw outside attention to the failings of my students.

他确实重写了。最终，那仍然至多只能算一篇勉强及格的论文。他的成绩从 F 提高到了 C。我觉得自己的介入产生了一些积极效果，但仍然并不完整。我们进行过一次三十分钟的谈话；后来我把论文还给他时，又有过一次更短的交流，并肯定了他在重写中投入的努力——这些努力确实很大，也足以让他得到更高的成绩。但他究竟学到了什么？也许他学会了怎样成为一个更好的研究者，也明白 Breitbart 之类的网站不能在大学课程中作为二手资料使用。如果要说还有什么，他可能只是更懂得在未来的学术写作中隐藏自己的种族主义信念。我遗憾的是，我几乎没有任何真正的渠道继续跟进他，也没有一个具体的地方可以把他转介过去；我只能让他进入大学二年级。那次作业和我们的讨论都发生在学期末。他进入这门课时准备得很差，而离开时，也只是稍微更有能力应对未来的写作任务而已。那个学期我一共有 75 名学生。另有不少学生会主动来找我寻求额外帮助，而对于 Toby，显然所有一对一交流都必须由我主动发起。除此之外，我当时还正努力争取续聘——这件事消耗了大量时间和精力，也使我不太愿意对那些需要给我教学评价的学生施加太大压力，更不用说因为学生的问题而引起外部关注。

It is in the context of this situation with Toby, my perpetual status as a contingent faculty member, and the imaginative connection I drew between my students and the Charlottesville protesters that I think about teaching our letter. First of all, I think my interaction with Toby highlights the necessity of foregrounding discussions about race and race issues in writing classes. All of the first-year writing classes I teach place an emphasis on being process-based, which means that instructors and students are to address the writing process first and foremost, while the topics about which students write take a back seat to our exploration to the work of drafting and revising. In Toby’s class, we had focused on a variety of current events—from topics related to digital technology as well as current political debates. Many of these caused us to touch upon considerations of race, but none of which forced students to engage directly with it. I had, after all, encouraged my students to “write about what interests you.” I think this is not just my own shortcoming but also a systemic problem of college writing courses as they are frequently taught to first and second year students all across the country. Historically, these courses have been used to teach rhetoric—an academic discipline that has seemingly been erased from first-year writing course design. In its place we are left with a pedagogy in which whatever subject matter is taken up is ultimately put to the service of learning and exploring the writing process. I think the current outburst of white nationalist violence is, among other things, a call to trouble the ubiquity of the process-based approach.

正是在 Toby 的这段经历、我长期作为非终身编制教师的处境，以及我在自己的学生与夏洛茨维尔抗议者之间建立的想象性联系这些背景下，我开始思考应该如何用我们的公开信进行教学。首先，我认为自己与 Toby 的互动凸显了一个必要性：在写作课堂中，应当把关于种族以及种族问题的讨论放到更前面的位置。我教授的所有一年级写作课程都强调“以过程为中心”，也就是说，教师和学生首先关注的是写作过程本身，而学生究竟写什么主题，则退居到起草与修改训练之后。在 Toby 所在的班里，我们讨论过很多时事——既有数字技术相关议题，也有当时的政治争论。许多话题都会触及种族问题，但没有一个真正迫使学生直接面对它。毕竟，我一直鼓励学生“写你感兴趣的东西”。我认为这不仅仅是我个人的不足，也是全美大学一、二年级写作课程常见的制度性问题。从历史上看，这类课程曾用于教授修辞学，但这个学科似乎已经从一年级写作课程设计中消失了。取而代之的是一种教学法：无论课堂采用什么主题，最终都只是服务于学习和探索写作过程。我认为，当前白人民族主义暴力的爆发，至少在某种意义上要求我们重新质疑这种“以过程为中心”方法的普遍性。

To me, it is clear how the process-based approach mediated my intervention with Toby. I spoke to him about improving the process by which he evaluated and chose sources. I felt uneasy addressing the racist content of his research essay directly because race and racism had not been an issue we had studied directly as a class. I did not want him to feel attacked, and I have always placed little stock in the efficacy of confrontations in changing a student's future thinking and behavior. It could be said that my class's indirect focus on the writing process allowed me to address Toby's racist attitudes in a less threatening and possibly more effective way. However, ultimately I find this rationale inadequate. The problem is, at its root, the process-based model would suggest that a racist essay that is well-written and researched should be evaluated the same as an anti-racist essay that is equally well-written and researched. It strikes me that this is almost precisely the logic exploited by the so-called alt-right and by the Trump Administration. This is the same logic that encourages Peter Cvjetanovic to claim being pro-white does not make him anti-anybody else, and it is the same logic by which President Trump could discuss the violence "on all sides" days after the Charlottesville protests.

在我看来，“以过程为中心”的方法显然塑造了我对 Toby 的介入方式。我与他谈的是如何改进评估和选择资料来源的过程。由于种族与种族主义并不是我们全班曾经直接学习过的议题，我对于直接讨论他研究论文中的种族主义内容感到不安。我不希望他觉得自己受到攻击，而且我一向并不太相信正面对抗能够有效改变学生未来的思考和行为。也可以说，课程对写作过程的间接强调，使我得以用一种威胁性更小、或许也更有效的方式处理 Toby 的种族主义态度。然而，最终我仍认为这种解释并不充分。问题的根源在于，“以过程为中心”的模式似乎意味着：一篇写得好、研究充分的种族主义论文，应当与一篇同样写得好、研究充分的反种族主义论文得到相同评价。在我看来，这几乎正是所谓“另类右翼”和特朗普政府所利用的逻辑。同样的逻辑让 Peter Cvjetanovic 可以声称，“支持白人”并不意味着“反对其他任何人”；也正是这种逻辑，使特朗普总统能够在夏洛茨维尔抗议数日之后谈论“各方（all sides）”的暴力。

Ultimately, these experiences have led me to reflect upon ways in which the neoliberal academy is complicit in producing such moral relativism, and most damningly on how the field of composition, in its goals to bring the processes of academic writing to traditional and nontraditional, well-prepared and ill-prepared students alike, has been so effectively co-opted by neoliberal moral relativism, and has been almost totally incapable of creating conditions, such as manageable course loads and permanent contracts, by which the writing process can be meaningfully and responsibly taught. I am not criticizing excellent research on the best practices for teaching freshman writing, nor am I criticizing my excellent colleagues who deal valiantly with this far-from-perfect situation. What I am criticizing is the conditions on the ground—i.e., the way in which the courses I am asked to teach, and the compromises necessary for me to be able to teach them, create a bastardized approach in which students are consumers, teachers are content providers, and race and racism become just one of the myriad banal matters a college writing class might or might not address.

归根结底，这些经历使我开始反思：新自由主义大学体制如何参与生产这种道德相对主义；更值得批判的是，写作教学这一领域原本试图把学术写作过程带给传统与非传统学生、准备充分与准备不足的学生，却如何被新自由主义式的道德相对主义如此有效地收编，并且几乎完全无力创造真正能够负责任、有意义地教授写作过程的条件，例如可管理的教学负担和长期稳定的合同。我并不是在批评关于大学一年级写作最佳教学实践的优秀研究，也不是在批评那些勇敢应对这种远非理想处境的优秀同事。我要批评的是实际的制度条件——也就是说，我被要求教授课程的方式，以及为了能够继续教这些课而不得不做出的妥协，最

终制造出一种被扭曲的教学模式：学生成了消费者，教师成了内容提供者，而种族与种族主义则沦为大学写作课堂可能谈、也可能不谈的无数日常议题之一。

For example, consider first-year writing's widely used textbook, W. W. Norton's They Say/I Say, which in its attempts at demystification, comes close to suggesting all writing is a game of Mad-Libs. According to They Say/I Say, the writer endeavors to locate and copy an already existing template for any specific genre. I have used this text in my courses, but in the last few years, I have stopped using it. This is because given the circumstances in which I teach, I find I barely have the time or the resources to even begin to complicate They Say/I Say's troubling, transactional, paint-by-numbers approach.

例如，可以看看 W. W. Norton 出版、被一年级写作课程广泛使用的教材《They Say/I Say》。它试图让写作变得不再神秘，却几乎把一切写作都说成了一场 Mad-Libs 式的填空游戏。按照《They Say/I Say》的逻辑，写作者只需要为某一种具体文类找到一个已经存在的模板，然后照着套用。我曾在课堂上使用这本书，但近几年已经停止使用。原因是，在我所处的教学条件下，我几乎没有足够的时间或资源，去真正把《They Say/I Say》这种令人不安、交易式、按数字涂色般的写作方法复杂化、问题化。

In the three semesters since my interaction with Toby, I have made race a much more central topic in my classes. Texts such as bell hooks's "In Our Glory: Photography and Black Life," John Edgar Wideman's "Looking at Emmett Till," excerpts of Claudia Rankine's Citizen, Ta-Nehisi Coates's Between the World and Me, Vershawn Ashanti Young's "Should Writer's Use They Own English?" and various texts from publically available Black Lives Matter syllabuses have become mainstays of my teaching, as I have attempted to tie them to students' own investigations into, and critical reflections upon, their own experiences. In teaching texts such as these, I encounter my students' silence and am faced with the difficulty of unpacking the roots of this silence. I think it is a combination of many factors, including that they feel sick of talking about race and racism, that they feel the strictures of political correctness circumscribe the expression of their incomplete and complex thoughts, that they fear alienation from their peers, that they understand the concept of white privilege at the same time that they do not feel particularly privileged themselves, and, perhaps above all, that they have learned to separate their actual feelings and ideas from what they are willing to discuss in class. It may very well be that my students have learned a sophisticated rhetorical flexibility that they use to navigate such discussions. As such, they readily apply a concept I am tasked with teaching to their own goal of avoiding discomfort.

自从与 Toby 的那次互动之后，三个学期以来，我在课堂中把种族问题放到了更核心的位置。bell hooks 的《In Our Glory: Photography and Black Life》、John Edgar Wideman 的《Looking at Emmett Till》、Claudia Rankine《Citizen》的节选、Ta-Nehisi Coates 的《Between the World and Me》、Vershawn Ashanti Young 的《Should Writer's Use They Own English?》，以及公开可获取的 Black Lives Matter 教学大纲中的各种文本，都逐渐成为我教学中的固定材料。我试图把这些文本与学生对自身经验的调查和批判性反思联系起来。在教授这些文本时，我会遭遇学生的沉默，也不得不面对一个难题：这种沉默究竟从何而来。我认为它来自多种因素：他们已经厌倦谈论种族和种族主义；他们觉得"政治正确"的约束限制了自己表达尚未成熟、复杂想法的空间；他们害怕被同伴疏远；他们理解"白人特权"的概念，同时自己又并不觉得特别有特权；或许最重要的是，他们已经学会把自己真实的感受和想法，与自己愿意在课堂上说出来的内容区分开。很可能，我的学生已经学会了一种相当成熟的修辞灵活性，并用它来应对这类讨论。因此，他们可以非常熟练地把我本来需要教授的某种修辞能力，反过来用于实现自己的目标——避免不适。

In this situation, I am not sure our letter makes for a good teaching tool after all. From other teachers, what I gather mostly is that it is being used to dramatize the process by which two white guys spoke up about their famous racist ancestor. Our claim to authority owes only to our blood relationship. In this way, our authority is constructed as the mirror opposite of any white person who finds identity and authority by participating in a white nationalist rally or writing on a white nationalist website. Moreover, our letter, while it drew much attention, has not played any role that I can see in hastening the removal of Confederate monuments in Richmond. Instead, we have been lauded for standing up as so-called allies speaking for racial justice. We have also experienced a strain of progressive back-patting in which it seems to me that what people admire is the chance Warren and I took to (briefly) unburden ourselves of our racist inheritance in a loud and public manner. The letter then has functioned as a public display of white-unburdening, one that is celebrated and even envied by similarly burdened, similarly progressive white people. My main reflection then is that we, mostly, and despite better intentions, preached to the choir and the choir applauded. What I will say to my students, and what I hope to demonstrate to them, is that they can construct their authority to write through reading and research,

through talking to different people, by participating in communities, and by thinking critically about the communities in which they participate. In short, they can construct their authority to speak and write on important issues out of so much more than their genealogy. Our letter might be a starting point for helping students develop ethos, but it cannot be an ending point.

在这种情况下，我已经不确定我们的公开信最终是否真是一件好的教学工具。据我从其他教师那里了解到的情况，它大多被用来戏剧化地展示这样一个过程：两个白人男子如何站出来谈论自己那位著名、带有种族主义色彩的祖先。我们声称拥有发言权，唯一的依据只是血缘关系。这样一来，我们的权威被建构成一种镜像的反面：一边是通过参加白人民族主义集会、或在白人民族主义网站上写作来获得身份和权威的白人；另一边则是我们。此外，虽然我们的公开信引发了很多关注，但据我所见，它并没有在推动里士满移除南方邦联纪念碑方面发挥任何实际作用。相反，我们因为以所谓“盟友”的身份为种族正义发声而受到称赞。我们还经历了一种进步派内部相互拍肩称赞的氛围。在我看来，人们真正欣赏的，是 Warren 和我抓住机会，以一种高调、公开的方式，短暂地卸下了自己继承的种族主义负担。因此，这封信实际上成了一场“白人卸下负担”的公开展示——那些同样背负这种负担、同样自认进步的白人不仅庆祝它，甚至羡慕它。我的主要反思是：尽管我们的初衷更好，但我们大体上只是“向唱诗班布道”，而唱诗班也为我们鼓掌。我会告诉学生、也希望向他们证明，他们可以通过阅读和研究、与不同的人交谈、参与社区，以及批判性地思考自己所参与的社区，来建立自己写作的权威。简言之，他们在重要议题上建立发言和写作权威的基础，完全可以远远超出自己的家族血缘。我们的公开信或许可以成为帮助学生发展修辞人格与可信度（ethos）的一个起点，但绝不能成为终点。

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